The rule's comparison at baseline v7

One unseen public point a process, the index calculus against Pollard rho on that same point, at ledger §23′s six sizes, 64 targets and four A/A repeats a size: 408 rows, every one checked, every logarithm §23′s. v7 is v6 with R11′s streamed pair-table build. Run on 2026-10-16 on an Emerald Rapids host of the reference class. Protocol: `research/ic_tool_program/rule/v7/PROTOCOL.md`.

- **Verdict (§23′s):** online the index calculus is faster than rho at all six sizes (14.1–37.0×). Cold, rho is still faster at all six.
- **Distance remaining:** rho is 3.43–11.51× faster cold (rule v6: 3.78–12.06×; rule v3: 5.23–20.97×). At the three largest sizes it is 7.03, 6.37 and 11.51× (v6: 7.90, 7.40, 12.06×; v3: 13.24, 12.03, 20.97×). The gap grows as r^0.144 [0.092, 0.196].
- **Checks:** 408 of 408 rows pass the `vs_rho` claim check (verified_answer_controlled_wall); the pin held; the reference check is admissible at every size (rho at 0.57–0.78 of the strong walk's time a step); five rows' contended first attempts re-ran clean.
- **Pricing (AGENTS.md §5a):** both arms are timed in one process, so no native work is unpriced on either arm, and the 0 / 0.1 / 1 GAE band gives one figure.

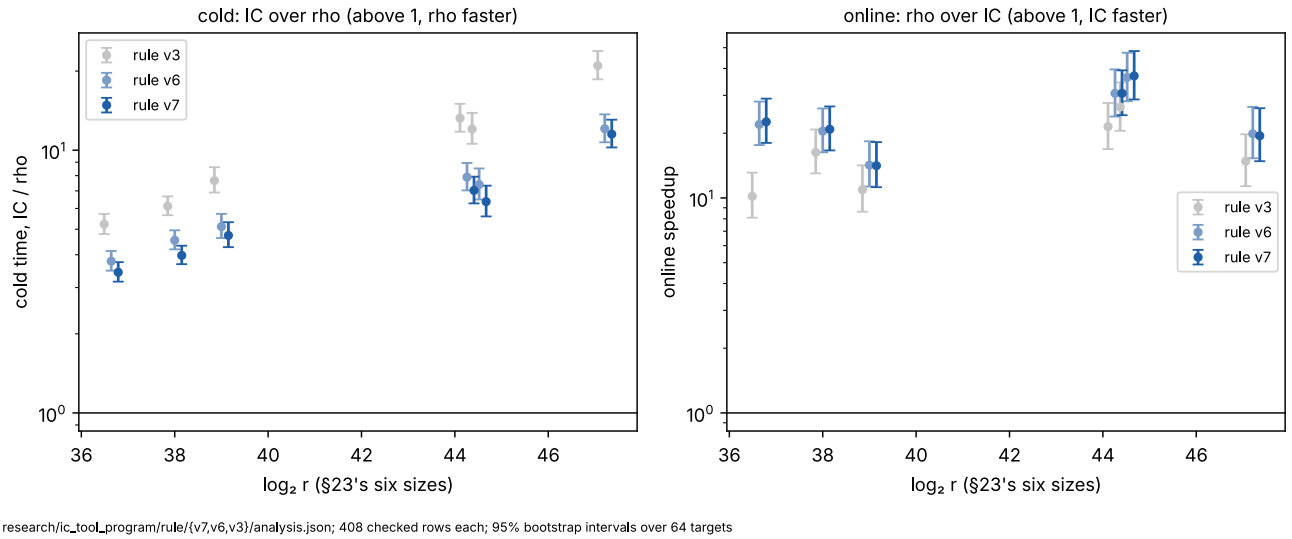


Figure 1: Left: cold time, IC over rho (above 1, rho faster). Right: online speedup, rho over IC. Rules v3, v6 and v7; 95% bootstrap intervals over 64 targets.

curve	$\log_2 r$	cold, v7 [95%]	cold, v6	cold, v3	online, v7	rho / strong
`icv1-f2m47-t22705043-f4e44623`	36.64	3.43 [3.16, 3.75]	3.78	5.23	22.59	0.78
`icv1-f2m57-tm747311035-c1f545af`	38.0	3.97 [3.68, 4.33]	4.54	6.12	20.87	0.57
`icv1-f2m41-tm2308219-7f48b14a`	39.0	4.74 [4.27, 5.32]	5.12	7.66	14.13	0.76
`icv1-f2m53-tm56619371-dac20a85`	44.26	7.03 [6.27, 7.93]	7.9	13.24	30.66	0.72
`icv1-f2m59-tm943548413-98844ecc`	44.52	6.37 [5.6, 7.33]	7.4	12.03	36.97	0.73
`icv1-f2m61-t158598901-ab42b6c5`	47.21	11.51 [10.24, 13.06]	12.06	20.97	19.46	0.73